Akbar’s command on false charges

Tansen: A singer of legendary talent, whom Akbar poached from Panna. Became one of the luminaries of Akbar’s court

Hakim Abul Fath: A Sunni refugee from Shia Iran who became a great favourite of Akbar’s. Was part of the disastrous military campaign in which Birbar died

Amir Fathullah Shirazi: A man of many talents, from astrology to mechanics. Was invited to Akbar’s court and led some of his administrative reforms, though he did not encourage Akbar’s theological adventurism

Bir Singh Bundela: Son of Raja Madhukar of Orchha. Allied with Prince Salim and assassinated Abul Fazl

Missionaries

Father Rudolf Aquaviva: Leader of the first Jesuit mission to Akbar’s court

Father Antonio Monserrate: One of the three priests who comprised the first Jesuit mission to Akbar’s court (along with Father Rudolf Aquaviva and Father Francis Henriquez). Was appointed tutor to Murad and other children of the nobility. Wrote an account of his experiences, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate, S.J. on his Journey to the Court of Akbar*

Father Hierosme (Jerome) Xavier Navarrois: Leader of the third Jesuit mission to Akbar’s court. Travelled with Akbar’s camp to Kashmir and on his last campaign to Khandesh

Chieftains, Kings and Queens

Sher Shah Suri: Founder of the Suri dynasty. Evicted Humayun and his brothers from Hindustan

Salim (Islam) Shah Suri: Sher Shah Suri’s son and successor. His death led to a succession battle that allowed Humayun to return to Hindustan

Muhammad Adil (Mubariz Khan): Claimed the Suri throne after Salim Shah Suri died, murdered Salim Shah’s young son

Hemu (Raja Bikramjit): A grocer who rose to administrative and military command in the Suri court. Brilliant general and de facto regent to Muhammad Adil. Defeated Mughal forces in Delhi and titled himself Raja Bikramjit. Lost the second battle of Panipat a few weeks later and was executed